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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCHSC202 - MENTAL WELL BEING OF ADOLESCENTS
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A
Short Answer Type Questions
Answer any 10 questions
Each question carries 2 marks [2x10 = 20]

1.What is vocational guidance? [K] / [CO2]
Vocational guidance refers to the process of helping individuals understand their abilities, interests, and personality traits in relation to various occupations (1 mark)
It assists them in making informed decisions about their educational and career paths to achieve satisfaction and success in their chosen field. (1 mark)
2.Define self-esteem. [K] / [CO5]
Self-esteem is the overall sense of a person's self-worth or personal value (1 mark)
It reflects how much an individual appreciates and likes themselves and influences confidence, motivation, and mental well-being (1 mark)
3.Explain how exercise contributes to coping with stress. [K] / [CO4]
Exercise helps in coping with stress by releasing endorphins, the body's natural mood elevators (1 mark)
Physical activity reduces muscle tension, improves sleep, and provides a distraction from stressors, enhancing emotional resilience (1 mark)
4.List two behavioral signs of phobia. [K] / [CO3]
Two behavioral signs of phobia include avoidance of feared situations or objects (1 mark)
Experiencing panic or anxiety symptoms when confronted with the phobic stimulus (1 mark)
5.Brief strategies for effective studying in college students. [U] / [CO5]
Effective studying strategies include maintaining a consistent study schedule, setting specific goals, taking regular breaks (1 mark) Using active learning techniques like summarization, and creating a distraction-free environment (1 mark)
6.Define academic pressure. [K] / [CO3]
Academic pressure refers to the stress and anxiety experienced by students (1 mark)
due to high expectations from parents, teachers, or self to perform well academically (1 mark)
7.What is meant by cyberbullying? [U] / [CO3]

Cyberbullying is the use of digital platforms such as social media, text messages, or emails to harass, threaten, or embarrass another person intentionally and repeatedly.(1 mark) Serious emotional and Psychological effects (1 mark)

8.Expand the term STD. [K] / [CO2]

STD stands for *Sexually Transmitted Disease*, (1 mark)

which refers to infections transmitted primarily through sexual contact, such as HIV, syphilis, and gonorrhea (1 mark)

9.Mention two physiological symptoms of stress. [U] / [CO3]

Common physiological symptoms of stress include increased heart rate, muscle tension, headaches (1 mark) Sweating, and disturbed sleep patterns (1 mark)

10.Mention two barriers to effective communication. [K] / [CO5]

Two barriers to effective communication are lack of attention or listening (1 mark)

the presence of emotional disturbances such as anger or anxiety (1 mark)

11.Define social development. [K] / [CO1]

Social development is the process of learning to interact effectively with others, form meaningful relationships (1 mark)

Adapt to social norms and values throughout different life stages (1 mark)

12. What is horticultural therapy? [K] / [CO4]

Horticultural therapy is the use of gardening and plant-based activities to promote mental and physical health (1 mark)

It helps reduce stress, improves mood, and enhances concentration and social skills (1 mark)

Part B
Short Essay Type Questions
Answer any 5 questions
Each question carries 4 marks [4x5 = 20]

13.Write a short note on the importance of early intervention in depression. [U]/[CO3]

Early intervention in depression is crucial to prevent the condition from worsening and leading to severe outcomes such as suicidal thoughts or substance abuse (2 marks)

Identifying symptoms like persistent sadness, fatigue, or loss of interest at an early stage allows timely counseling and treatment. Support from family, teachers, and peers helps adolescents cope better and recover faster (2 marks)

14.Discuss the importance of vocational counselling in career planning. [U] / [CO4]

Vocational counselling assists adolescents in understanding their strengths, interests, and aptitudes, enabling them to make appropriate career choices. It guides them in exploring job opportunities, acquiring necessary skills, and setting realistic career goals (2 marks)

Proper counselling reduces confusion, enhances motivation, and ensures better job satisfaction in the long term (2 marks)

15.Write short notes on the role of career talks in motivating adolescents. [U] / [CO4]

Career talks expose adolescents to various career options, inspiring them through real-life success stories and professional experiences. These talks enhance awareness about emerging fields, educational requirements, and skill development (2 marks)

They motivate students to set goals, plan their future, and work with confidence and purpose (2 marks)

16.Explain how emotional intelligence helps in building relationships. [U] / [CO1]

Emotional intelligence (EI) involves recognizing, understanding, and managing one's own emotions and those of others (2 marks)

High EI enables adolescents to communicate effectively, empathize, and manage conflicts positively. It fosters trust, cooperation, and deeper emotional bonds, strengthening friendships and family relationships (2 marks)

17.Describe four signs of media addiction in adolescents. [U] / [CO3]

Four signs of media addiction include excessive time spent online, neglect of studies or social interactions, irritability when disconnected from devices, and sleep disturbances (2 marks)

Overuse of social media or gaming can lead to anxiety, reduced concentration, and social isolation (2 marks)

18. Write short notes on the interrelationship between decision-making and problem solving. [U] / [CO5]

Decision-making and problem-solving : Interrelated cognitive processes. Effective decision-making requires identifying a problem, analyzing options, evaluating consequences, and choosing the best course of action (2 marks)

Strong problem-solving skills improve decision quality, while good decision-making enhances problem-solving efficiency (2 marks)

19.Write short notes on dance therapy as a medium of stress release. [U] / [CO4]

Definition : Dance therapy uses body movement as a form of emotional expression and physical release. It promotes relaxation, self-awareness, and self-expression, reducing anxiety and tension (2 marks)

Uses : The rhythmic movement improves mood by stimulating endorphins and fostering a sense of freedom and joy (2 marks)

Part C
Essay Type Questions
Answer any 1 questions
Each question carries 10 marks [10x1 = 10]

20.Define teenage pregnancy and discuss its causes and consequences in detail. [K] / [CO2]

Teenage pregnancy : Teenage pregnancy refers to pregnancy occurring in girls between the ages of 13 (2 Marks)

Causes : Major causes include lack of sex education, peer pressure, early sexual activity, poverty, and absence of parental guidance. In some cases, abuse or coercion also contributes (3 Marks)

Consequences : The consequences are both physical and psychological — complications during childbirth, higher maternal and infant mortality rates, school dropout, and social stigma. Teenage mothers often face emotional stress, economic hardship, and limited job opportunities (3 Marks)

Preventive strategies : include comprehensive sex education, promoting contraception awareness, and empowering adolescents to make informed reproductive choices (2 Marks)

21. Discuss the characteristics of adolescence in detail. [U] / [CO1]

Adolescence : Adolescence is the transitional stage between childhood and adulthood, marked by rapid physical, emotional, and cognitive changes (2 Marks)

Physical and emotional changes : Physically, puberty brings hormonal changes, growth spurts, and development of secondary sexual characteristics. Emotionally, adolescents experience mood swings, identity exploration, and self-consciousness. Socially, peer relationships become highly influential, and there is a desire for independence from parents (4 marks)

Cognitively, abstract thinking and decision-making abilities develop, but emotional regulation may still be immature. This stage is crucial for shaping personality, values, and mental well-being (4 marks)